

Nikhil Vinod

(510)-921-1959 | nikh.vinod@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Personal Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

Santa Clara University

Expected: Jun 2027

B.S. in Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics

- **Relevant Coursework:** Algorithms, Data Structures, Object-Oriented Programming, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Artificial Intelligence, Data Mining, Web Development, Probability & Statistics, Linear Algebra
- **Activities and Societies:** ACM, Theta Tau (Professional Engineering Fraternity), AI Collaborate

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, C++, C, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Dart, HTML/CSS
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** React.js, React Native, Next.js, Node.js, Flutter, FastAPI, Flask, Tailwind CSS
- **Tools & Cloud:** Git/GitHub, CI/CD, AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, S3), Google Cloud, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Firebase

EXPERIENCE

PayPal (Software Engineering Intern - Merchant Onboarding Team)

Jun 2026 - Sep 2026

- Built a Next.js application consolidating data from **10+** internal systems into a single triaging view (merchant account information, limitations, feature blockers, third-party details, etc.)
- Designed a DFS-based path enumeration algorithm over a dependency tree of requirements, computing minimal steps to unlock account capabilities and replacing manual case-by-case investigation
- Developed a timeline visualization of merchant onboarding journeys from first-party tracking data, showing engineers exactly where a merchant dropped off
- Became the primary triage tool for merchant account issues org-wide, eliminating the need for cross-team consultation

Way.com (Software Engineering Intern Consultant)

Jun 2025 - Sep 2025

- Built a React Native/TypeScript mobile application for 360° vehicle inspections with real-time WebRTC audio/video streaming and WebSockets
- Implemented a multi-step AI inspection workflow using LangGraph and Gemini vision models to evaluate photo quality and return pass/fail results for each inspection stage
- Extracted VINs from live video frames using Gemini and automatically retrieved vehicle details via the NHTSA API

JIFFY.ai (Software Engineering Intern Consultant: Full-Stack Developer)

Jun 2024 - Sep 2024

- Developed the end-to-end investment account onboarding journey for the Finley mobile app using Flutter, supporting multiple account types (Individual, Joint, IRA, and Education)
- Integrated various third-party tools: Plaid for data aggregation, Google Places API for address autocomplete functionality, and Twilio for phone verification
- Implemented AWS Lambda functions for serverless back-end API integration

JIFFY.ai (Software Engineering Intern)

Jun 2023 - Aug 2023

- Implemented automated user manual generation by leveraging JIFFY.ai APIs and GenAI models for dynamic documentation
- Developed reusable front-end React components for deployment on the JIFFY.ai platform, enhancing widget integration for client applications

PROJECTS

[Haggle](#) (1st Place Winner @ [xAI Hackathon](#)) | [Grok](#), [FastAPI](#), [Next.js](#), [React](#), [PostgreSQL](#), [Supabase](#), [WebSockets](#), [TypeScript](#)

- Built an autonomous voice negotiation agent using Grok LLM to gather user information, Grok Search to find local service providers, and Twilio and Grok Realtime Voice API for real-time phone negotiations
- Developed a Next.js dashboard to display live call statuses and final negotiation outcomes
- Won 1st place out of 350+ participants, earning a trip to a SpaceX launch and 550K+ views on the project demo

[MartIQ.ai](#) | [FastAPI](#), [React](#), [Playwright](#), [OpenAI](#), [PostgreSQL](#), [Supabase](#), [Python](#), [Vite](#), [Tailwind CSS](#)

- Built end-to-end food safety intelligence platform using Playwright automation to scrape county health inspection portals nationwide and an AI pipeline to parse inspection reports into structured data
- Developed a multi-tenant compliance dashboard and RAG-powered chatbot enabling enterprise clients to query inspection data across all their locations

[F1 Race Prediction Model](#) | [TensorFlow](#), [scikit-learn](#), [XGBoost](#), [LightGBM](#), [CatBoost](#), [Pandas](#), [NumPy](#)

- Built a machine learning pipeline to predict Formula 1 podium finishes using driver and race data via the FastF1 API
- Implemented predictive models (XGBoost, neural networks, LightGBM, CatBoost) and optimized performance through feature engineering, missing-data handling, and hyperparameter tuning
- Achieved 1.78 test MAE and 1.96 cross-validation MAE across 10 folds using an ensemble of the top-performing models